

Post Human HCI: thinking time differently

Seminar in the context of Professor Giuliana Vitiello's courses



INTERACTIVE
TECHNOLOGIES
INSTITUTE

Valentina Nisi, IST, U. lisboa
Salerno, September 2025 Seminar



UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI
DI SALERNO

Agenda...

NEXT - Framing of the Brief and the Mth temporalities first-person critical reflection tool

REST of the class: Start on the booklet – collage, annotation, critical unmaking of time- continued during the rest of the day if you can...

TOMORROW

2.5h - The timing assigned per activity might change depending on how many groups we have and how far you have gone with the booklet

1.30 h: Thinking things differently – Based on your first-person critical reflections, Design together - Groups work together to design a new time machine inspired by the field work

55 min: Groups' Presentations of the ideas



Brief: The More than Human TIME machine

BRIEF: **Design** (conceptualise) a **More than Human TIME machine:**

an interactive installation, object or website based on your critical reflections.

STEP 1: Choose a site for your critical engagement (through the booklet).

Choose among three volcanic sites: i) the Vesuvio volcanic mountain, ii) Campi Flegrei bradyseism site, iii) Ischia volcanic island.

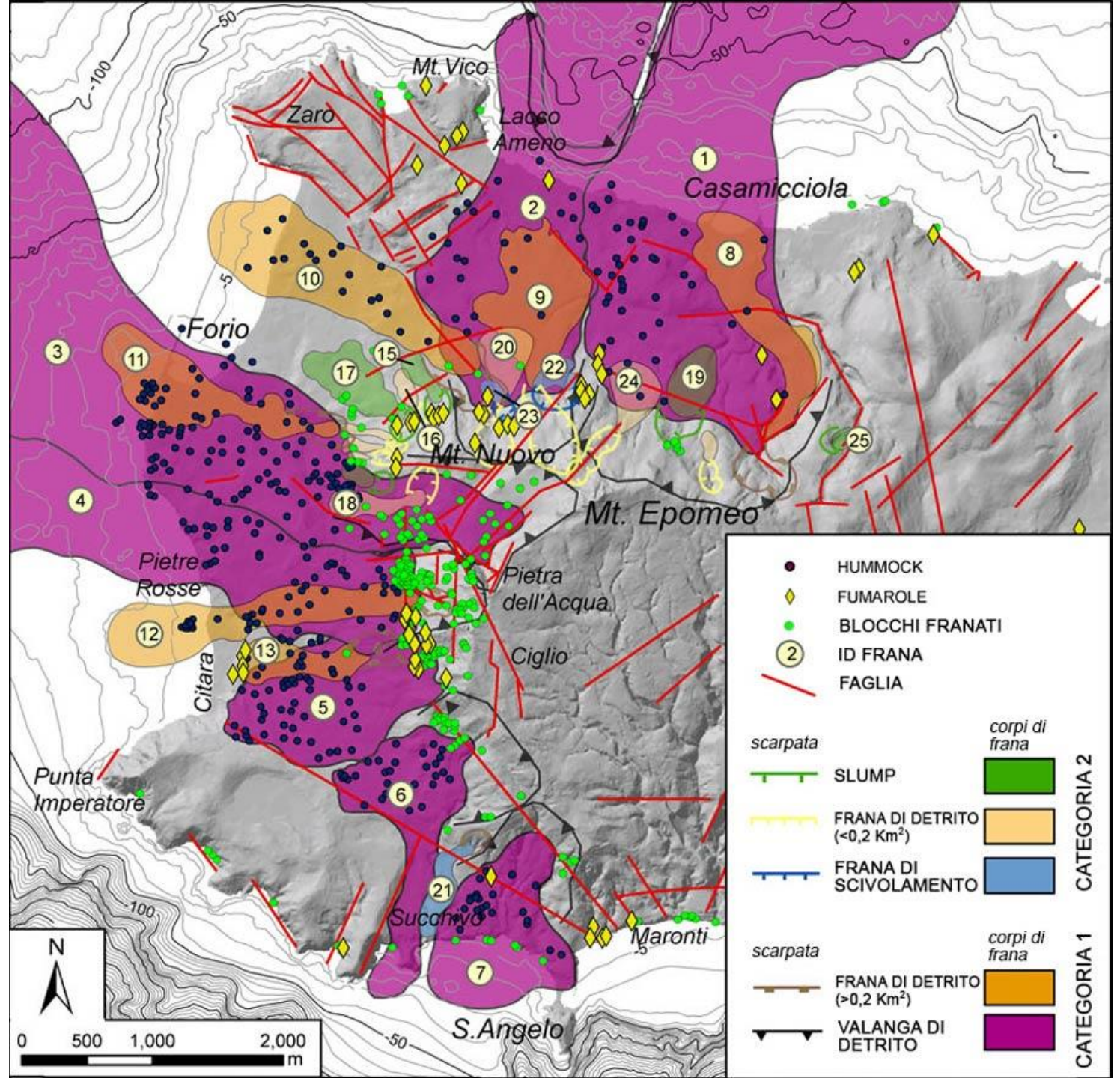
STEP 2: Individually (or in pairs) engage with the booklet page by page - Use collage, sketching, be creative. Research and critically engage with the site - Choose quickly- give it a few minutes, then dive into the booklet.— **do not waste time- 5 min max to choose.**

Some Images are printed for you, some we can print for you
and you can find a lot of extra Info from here:

- <https://www.ov.ingv.it/index.php/cf-inquadramento>



Isola di Ischia



Campi Flegrei



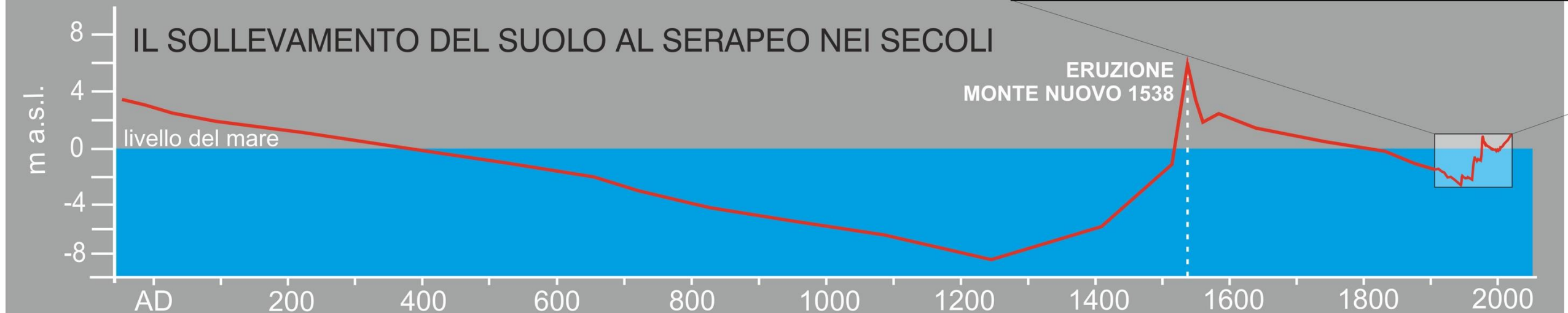
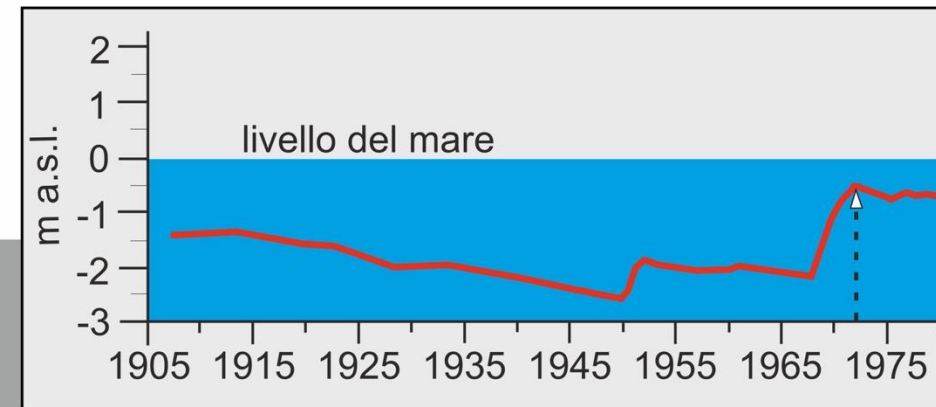
1930



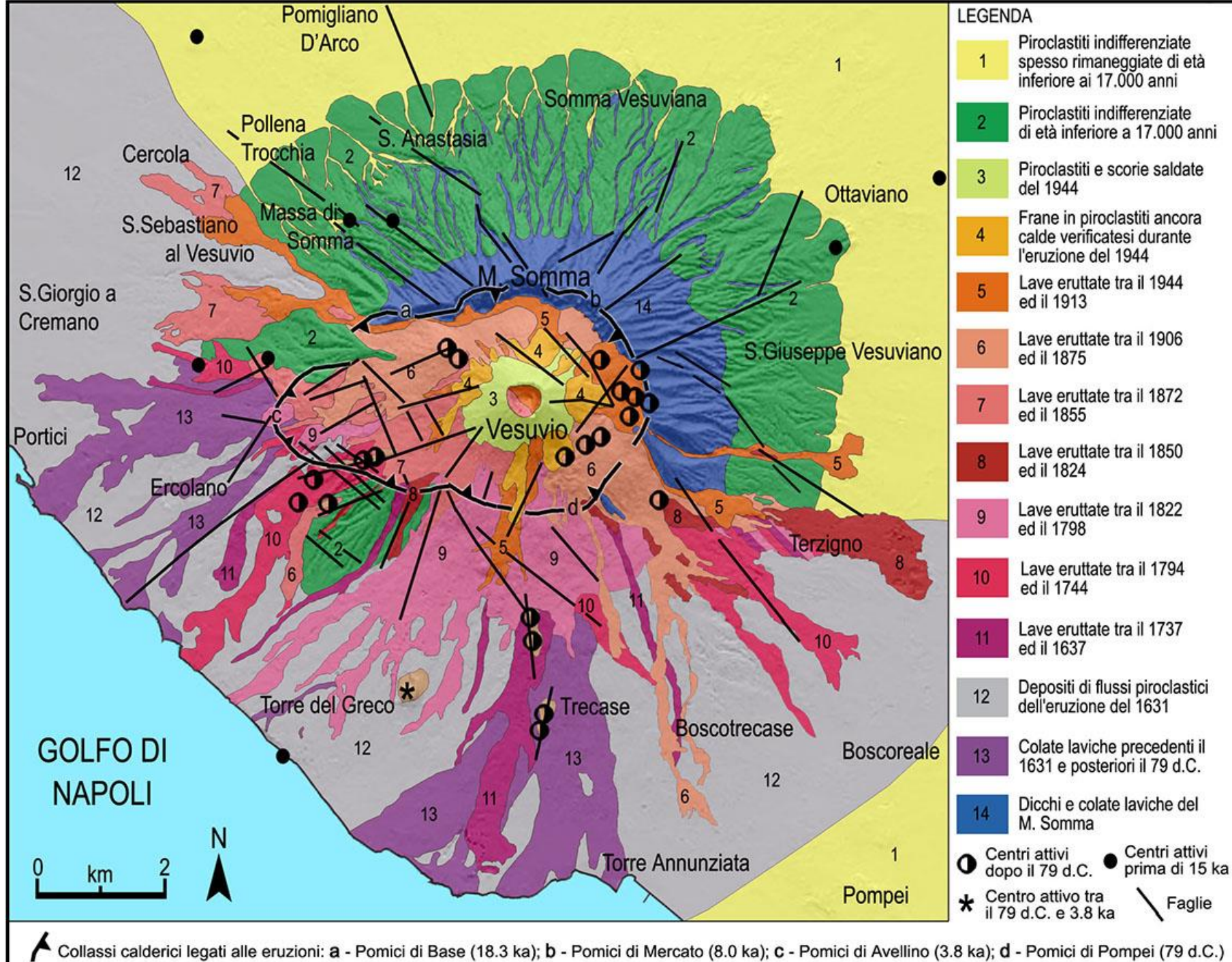
1970



oggi

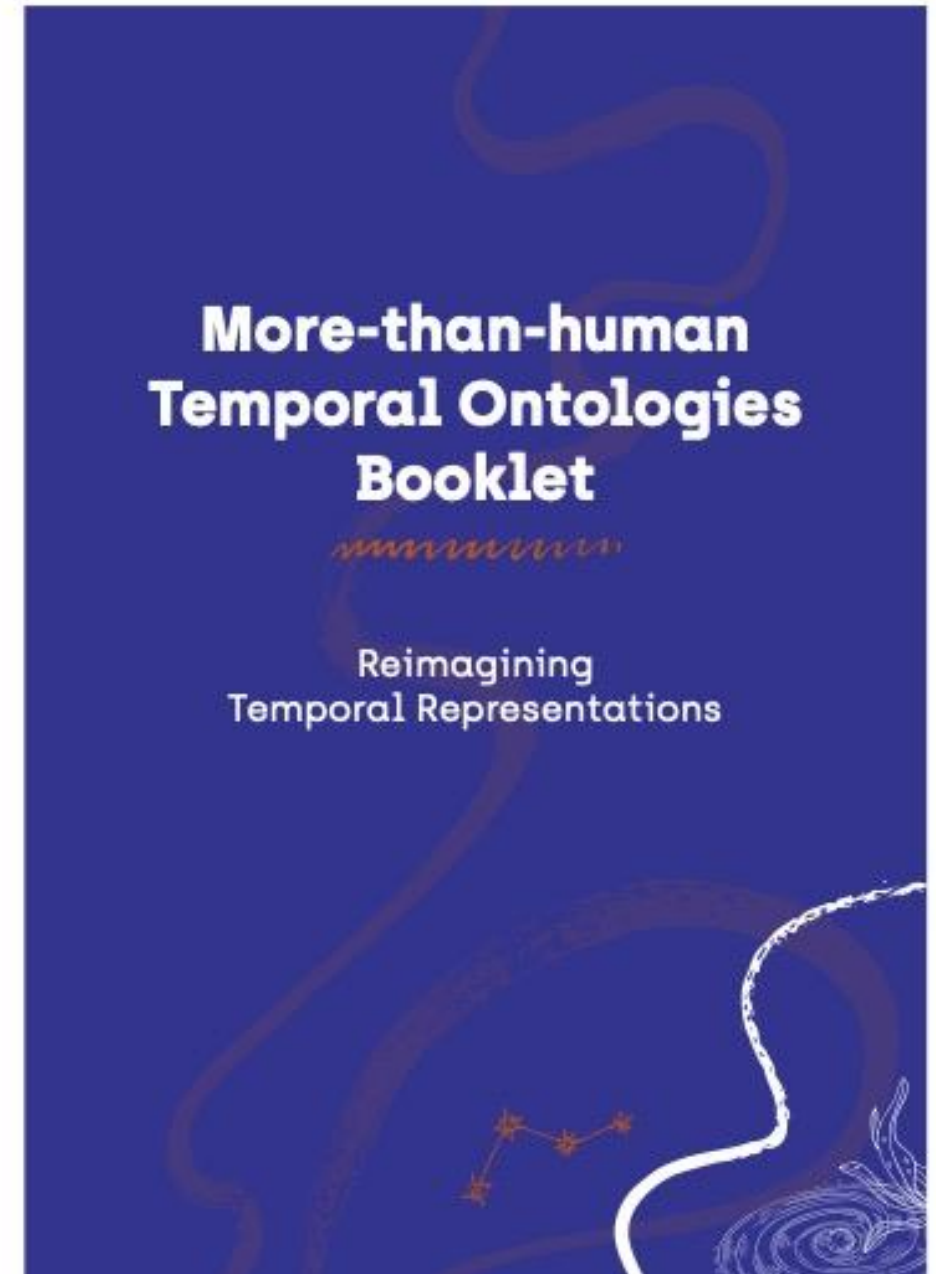


Vesuvio Mountain



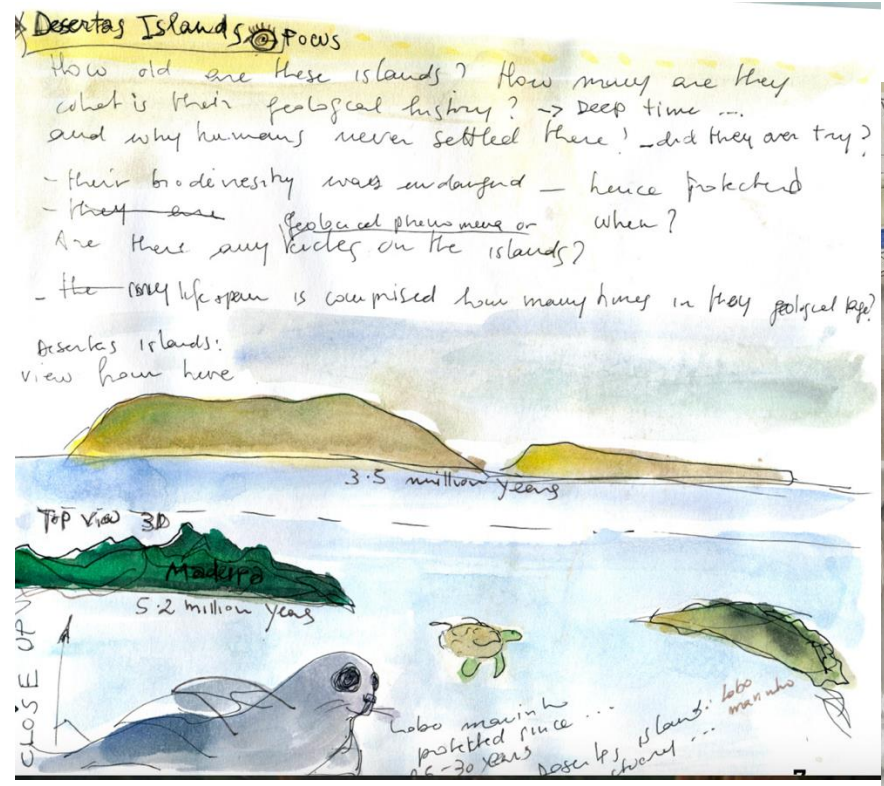
MtH temporalites booklet

- WE designed this booklet as an experiment: you are our first user 😊
- We propose a practical tool and design space for HCI and design researchers to structure dialogues, deconstructing and understandings time and temporalities in more inclusive and expansive ways
- By embodying, imagining, and sketching multiple expressions of more-than-human times, we invite participants to challenge current HCI approaches to time.
- I will explain it to you page by page



Part A. Building Awareness through Sketching, Noticing and Indexing

A1 Sketching, Noticing and Indexing:
Experiment with different views, close-ups and perspective changes.
How close or far do you want to capture what is around you?



Part A Building Awareness through Sketching, Noticing and Indexing

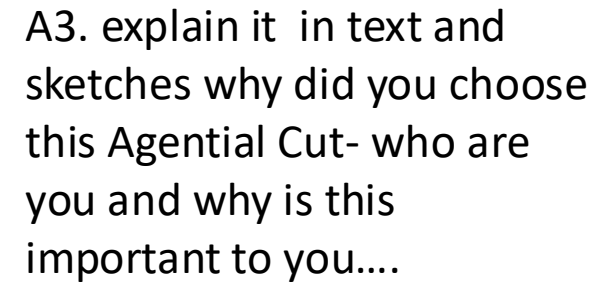
1

Sketching, Noticing and Indexing:
Zooming in and out, experiment with
panoramic views, close-ups and perspective
changes. Your choice is not only the location,
but also how close or far you want to capture
what is around you.



A3 Be reflexive:

Explain your positionality in a statement.



Part B.

Listing and mapping fluid polyphonic assemblages

B1

List the More-than-Humans (Mth) present in your sketch:

For each species (or just for one or two), reflect and write down the following:

- How long does this species last/ live for?
- What relations does it hold to seasonal, yearly, and daily rhythms?
- How does it relate to human lifespan, if at all? ...

Add more annotations to your sketches after this exercise.

Part B

Listing and mapping fluid polyphonic assemblages

Accurately list and map the Mth ecologies – choose one of your sketches (if that helps).

1

Make a List of all the humans and more than humans present in your sketch. You can go back to the sketch and add more if you notice more during this exercise.

List what you see: species, materials, vegetation, now, before, after

- o Volcanic rocks formations
- o bushes dry and less dense
- o sand
- leaves running on the beach
- found grey stones
- red soil (side of mountain)
- dry grass on mountain
- the port
- the sailing boats
- the masts
- the cement factory
- the cement people



Write, sketch, collage – mix

2

Map human and Mth entanglements in what you sketched: highlight polyphonic assemblage – ask yourself, is it stable? Is it in flux (fluid)? What is the history of this place? How does it relate to humans and more-than-humans? (Stories, folklore, history...)

PART B - ... List

humans - come to be with the ocean daily or seasonally -

Focus 70-100 years

crabs of different colors and dimension

3 to 4 years

They come out when tide is low

seaweeds: from months to decades lifespan

→ what is their life span?

octopus: I saw octopus twice -

→ 3 to 5 years

under water and crawling up a rock

How long do they live?

Sea turtle: I saw sea turtle once - she spent the summer here

How long do they live?

monk seal: I saw the monk seal here for a whole late summer

Volcanic rocks - how old are they

from days to decades

shores on the shore - cello - protected - how long did it take to become so random

Many kinds of fish - bodiao - parrot fish. grey and red

other fish

very small fish from days to decades

50-90 years

clouds at the horizon - come and go with the winds everyday

Deserted Island - Rocks formations - Not inhabited by humans, but hold a series of biodiversity

Listing and mapping fluid polyphonic assemblages

Map Mth entanglements:

- What are they composed of?
- Is it stable? What elements are more stable?
- Is it in flux (fluid)? How does it change?
- What is its history?

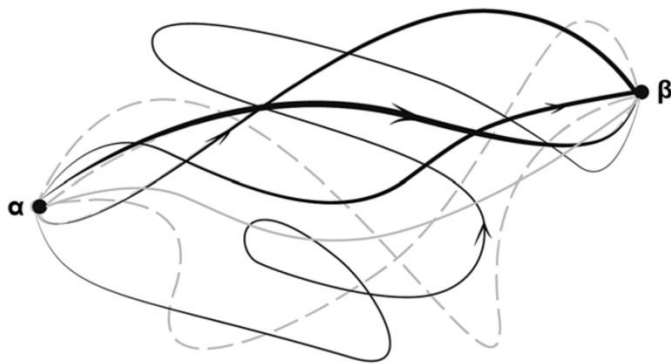
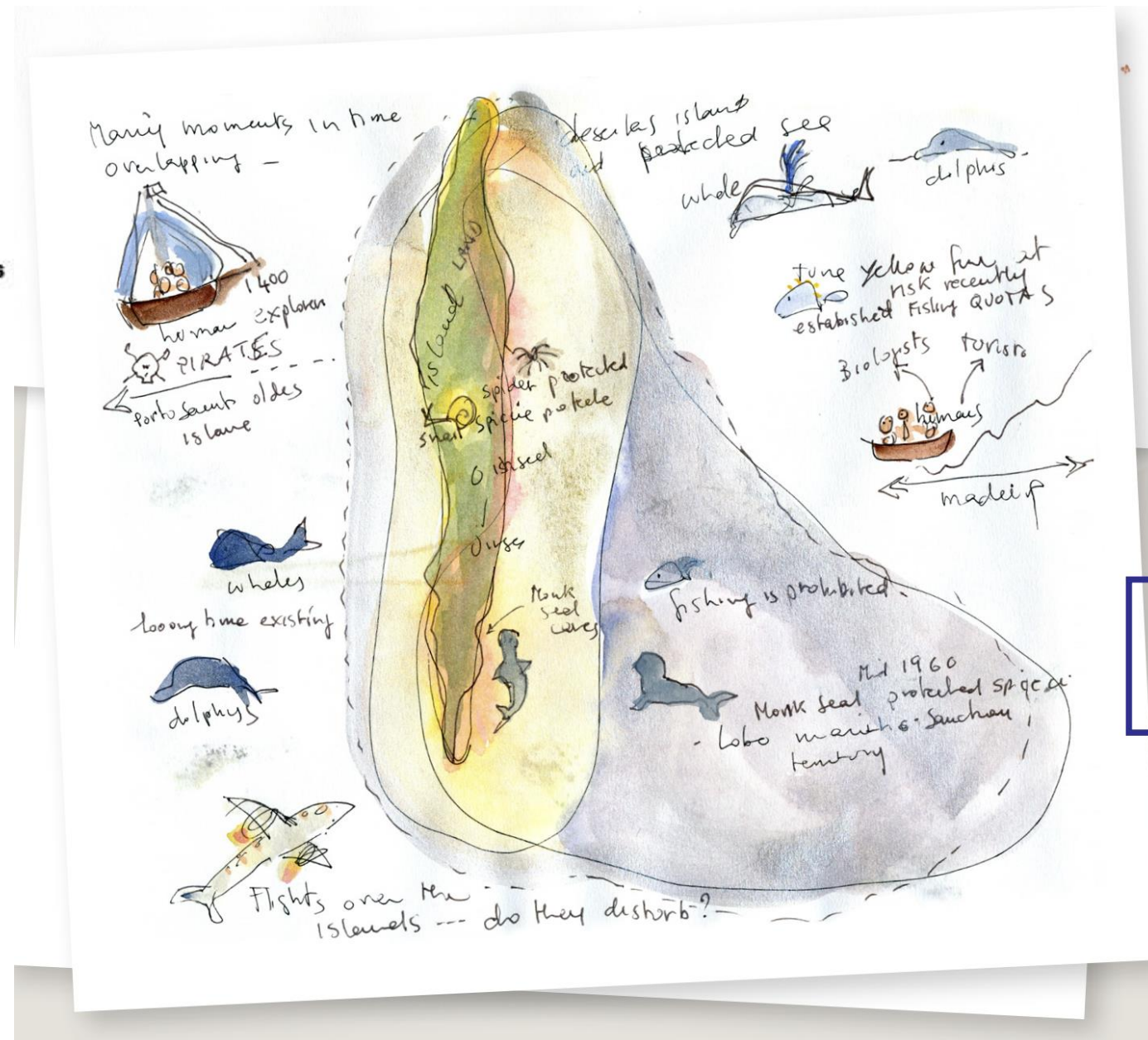
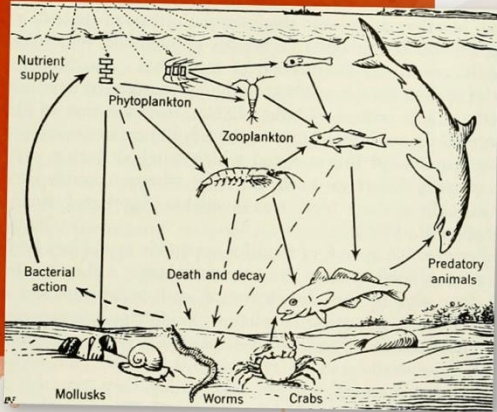
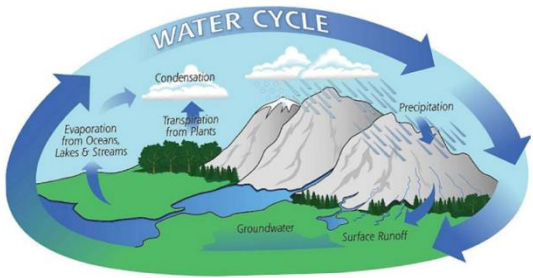


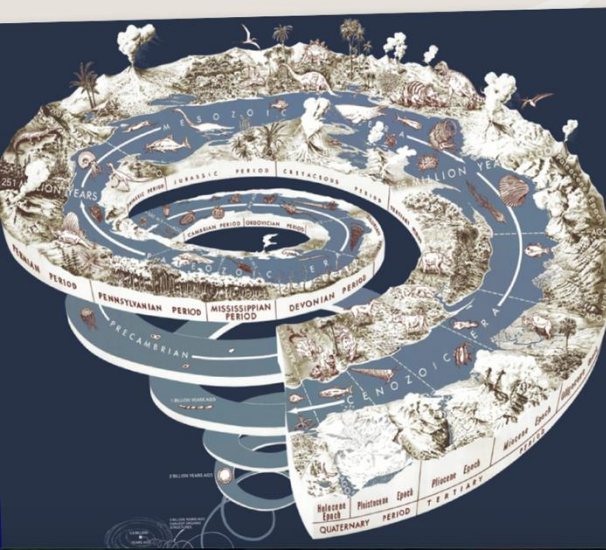
FIGURE 8.4 Karen Barad's (2018) diagram of quantum entanglement visualizes an infinite plurality of paths (hauntological sedimentations of virtual, possible, and actual) that configures and is reconfigured by any past/source point α and a future/destination point β . Source: Karen Barad and Elaine Gan, 2017.



Representing
time as a fluid
assemblage.



Elements of ecology, George L. Clarke (1954)



Part C.

Critical representations: critically place situated temporalities within existing frames of representation

C1

Consider traditional time representations while critically asking:

- What do they do well?
- What would be missing?
- How can we invent new ones?

UN-Linear

Represent and criticise some processes as Linear and Un-linear.

Part C.

Critical representations: critically place situated temporalities within existing frames of representation

UN-Spiral

Represent and criticise some processes as Spirals and Un-Spiral.

UN-Parallel

Represent and criticise some processes as Parallel and Un-parallel.

UN-Circular

Represent and criticise some processes as Circular and Un-circular.

Part C

Critical representations:

Critique and deconstruct traditional ways of representing time: What do they do well?
What would be missing? How can we invent new ones?

UN-Linear

Critique and represent some processes as Un-linear.



UN-CIRCULAR

→ the wind swirls
winds can circulate back, but then go forward and then chop and change
CIRCULARITY does capture the recurrent winds patterns like monsoons

UN-SPIRAL

spiralling out of control...
Spirals can go in both directions → chop course go forward and then spiral again inside

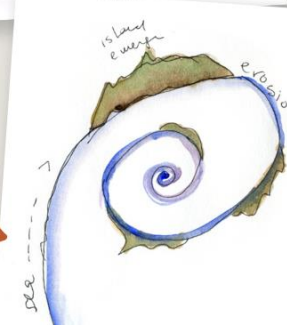
times repeats? but the same

UN-Circular

Critique and represent some processes as Un-circular

UN-Spiral

Critique and represent some processes as Un-Spiral.



UN-Parallel

Critique and represent some processes as Un-parallel.

UN-PARALLEL

→ Something is mismatched... can parallel really happen

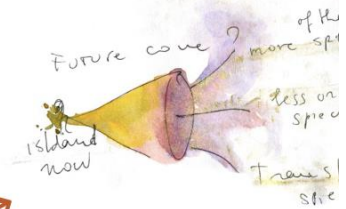
Could parallel capture potential entanglements - phenomena that do not behave the exact same - somehow connected?

UN-FUTURE CONE

→ how can we start a future prediction from one single point? maybe the future cone

UN-Futures Cone

Critique and represent some processes as an Un-future cone.

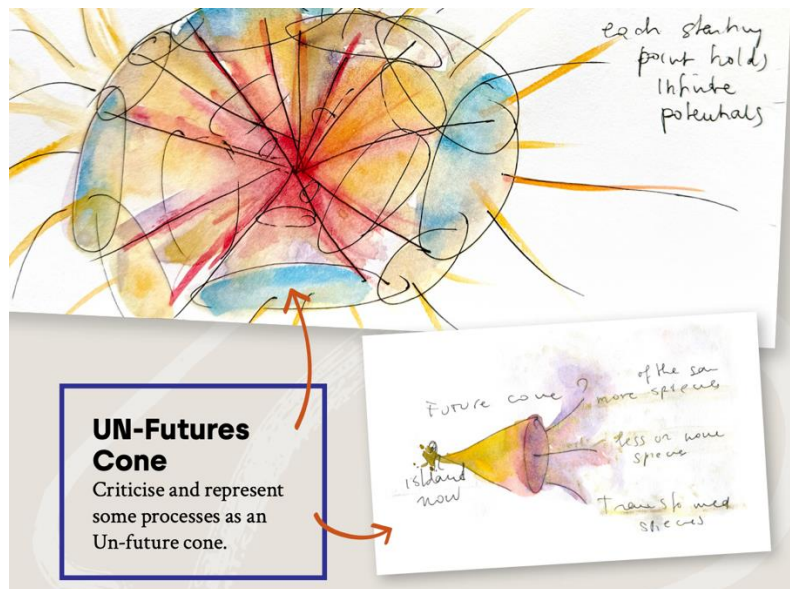


Part C.

Critical representations: critically place situated temporalities within existing frames of representation

UN-Futures Cone

Represent and criticise some processes as a Future and Un-Future cone.



Part D.

Expansion of Representations

D1

Rethink/combine representations in more fluid, polyphonic assemblages.

Be creative, interpret, imagine, reflect. Consider different temporal aspects (frequency, cadence, etc), different forms of temporal agency, different encounters and misencounters, and power dynamics (whose times are being defined by whom?).

Use Perspective to map time

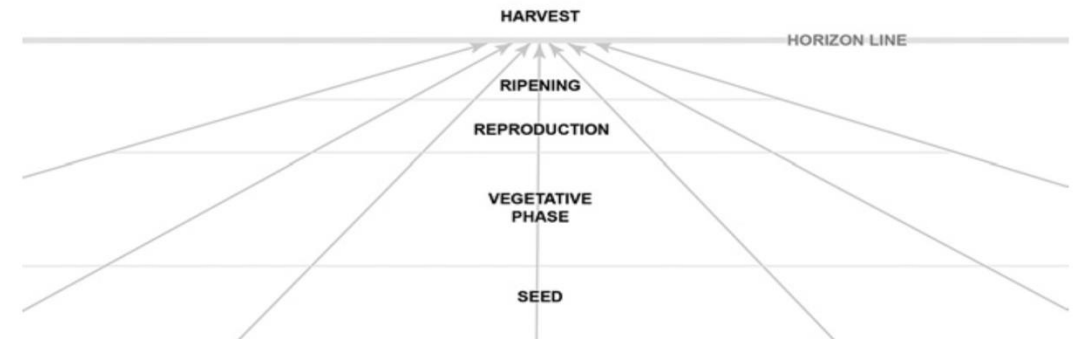
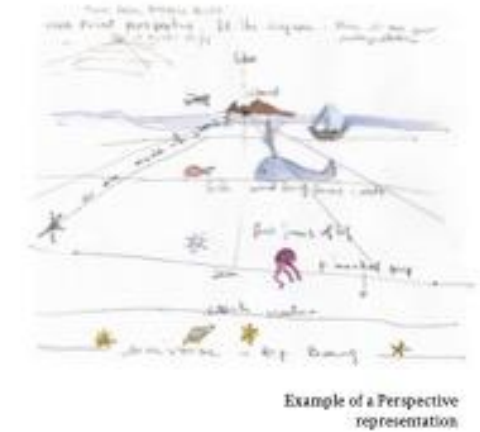


FIGURE 8.2 Rice agriculture is organized around “one-point temporality”—a future of bountiful harvest that depends on isolating rice from the temporalities of other species.

Part D. Expansion of Representations

Interpret time through a Conklin's diagram



Example of a Conklin's diagram
inspired representation

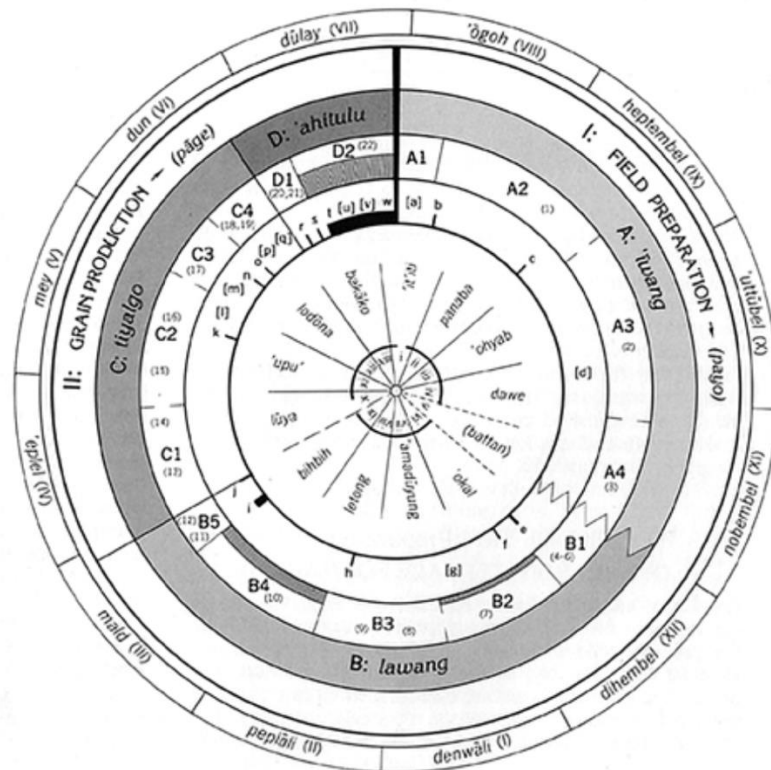


FIGURE 8.3 Harold Conklin represented an Ifugao calendar year as a set of nested activities. Source: Harold Conklin, *Ethnographic Atlas of Ifugao* (1980), 64.

Visualise Fluid Assemblages



Example of a Fluid Assemblage
representation

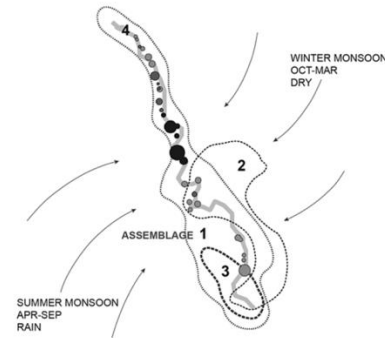
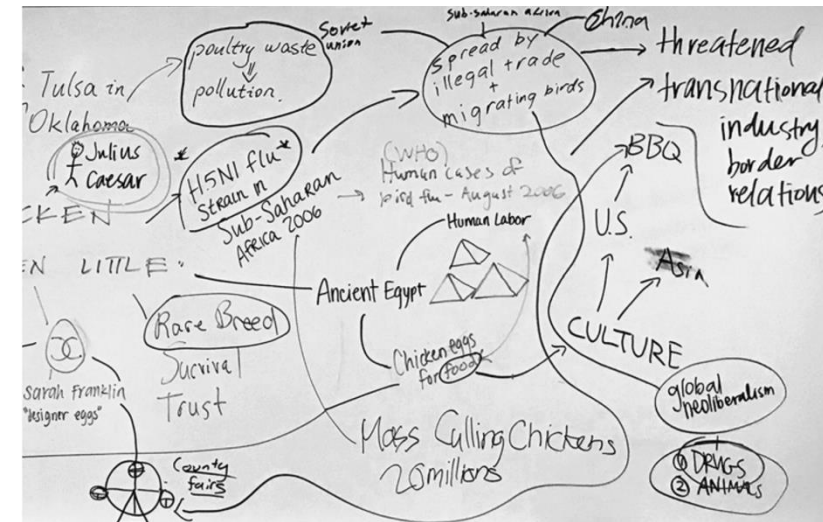


FIGURE 8.8 Working diagram to understand assemblages in flux. Source: Elaine Gan, 2018.



Reflect: Change, Relationality and Ethics

E1

E1

How is this different? What else did you learn/notice?

How do you feel? What did this exercise make you think of? Did this exercise affect the way you related to this temporal ontology? What ethical concerns emerge from undertaking this exercise? Reimagine your representation of this temporal ontology. How is this different? What else did you learn/notice?

fresh seaweed

tidal are regular

advice to sampling over climate change

fresh seaweed

litter are

drying seaweed

decomposing seaweed

seaweed 3 years

crabs live 4 years

foam lasts a few seconds

linear line of sea

do the last

waves under the sea and currents

linear area interacting

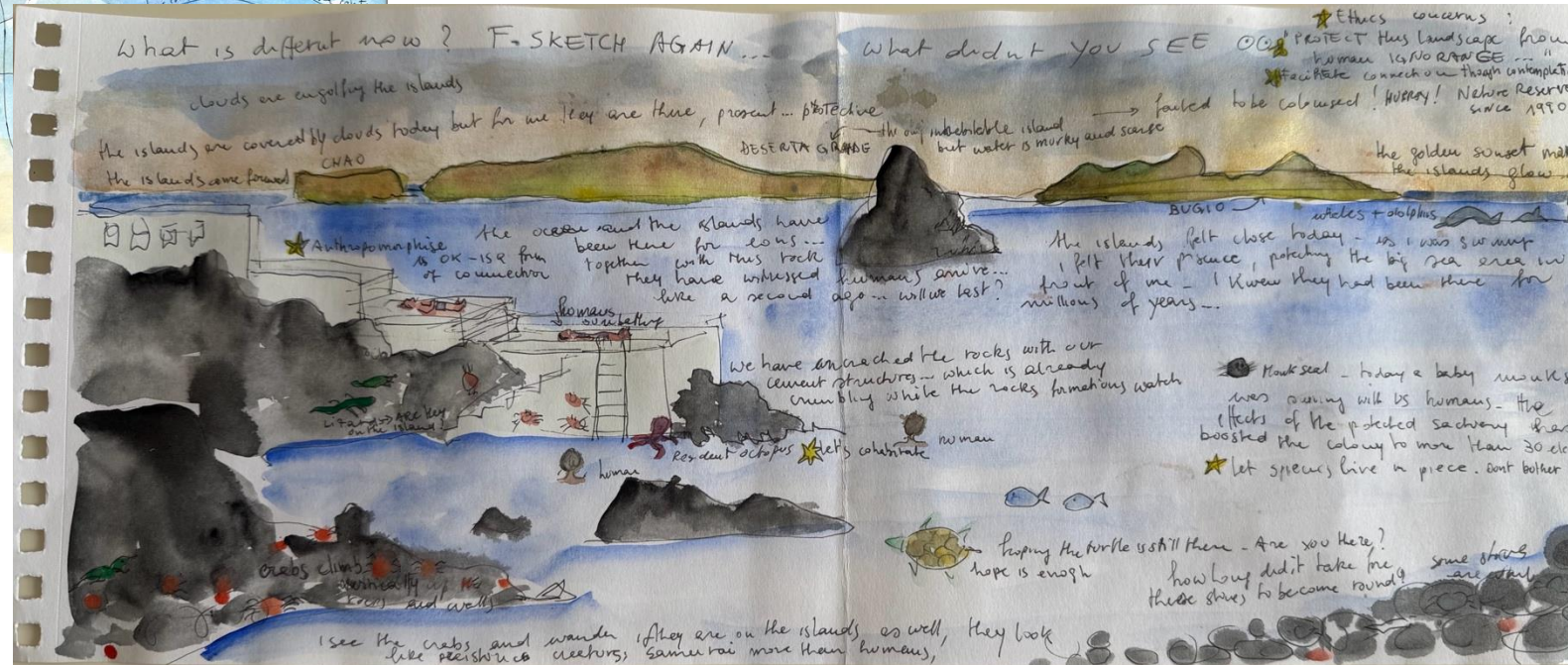
shape of waves on coast

rare star fish AUV

what is different in clouds are engulfing the islands are covered by cloud the is land of some forest CNAO

Autism

Write, sketch, collage – mix



...Three, two , one, go:
Compile the booklet individually

- Choose a landscape to engage with – Ischia, Campi Flegrei and Vesuvio (5 min max)
- Look at the provided images, cut, glue, sketch, and annotate-
If you can find all the printed versions here,
- if you want an image that is not available, we can print it for you
- Be curious, be creative, analyse and reflect critically ...

You have from now until tomorrow to finish the booklet

From tomorrow, you will work in groups for the rest of the time...

1,30h: Form a group (maybe choose people who looked at the same landscape)

Start a discussion synthesising your critical views of time-

Start brainstorming about the MtH TIME machine- share ideas- be inclusive (instead of BUT use AND...)

maintaining a clear goal of this installation or system-

Reflect and support reflection on more than human temporalities in a critical way

After one hour, start organising your presentation –

3h: How can you present this machine and explain it to your public in less than 5 min?

First, choose a meaningful title for your work and present it through images – sketches, collages –

Use text minimally

- What did you do in a nutshell (object, website, VR ?) 1 min
- Why? What is your message or intent? 1 min
- How does it connect to your critical reflections through the booklet
- How does it look - description -3 min